

Summary of Student Evaluations

Student evaluations are known to be faulty methods for evaluating instructor effectiveness in courses due to conscious and unconscious student biases as well as students not being subject matter nor pedagogical experts. Student evaluations do provide accurate representations of *satisfaction* with a course, which can be important for retainment. Interpreted student comments can also shed light on potential issues in a course. Therefore, as long as my quantitative evaluations are above 4.5 for each question, I focus only on student comments. Students have responded overwhelmingly positively to my methods of teaching courses at ERAU-W. As noted in my **[Reflection on Student Course Evaluations]**, 86/92 were entirely positive and noted the extensive feedback I provide students, the numerous helpful resources I have when needed, and the accepting environment I engender with my process over product mentality. A summary of student evaluations by term, compared to college instructor evaluation average, are provided in a table below.

			# Students	# Respond	% Respond	Instructor Experience Mean	College IE Mean	Positive Comments to Instructor	Neutral Comments to Instructor	Negative Comments to Instructor
Term	Year	Course	421	268	64%	4.67	NA	86	6	0
September	2021	MATH 143	17	12	71%	4.48	4.55	3	1	
October	2021	MATH 111	10	9	90%	4.81	NA	4		
October	2021	MATH 143	25	19	76%	4.59	NA	6		
January	2022	MATH 111	29	16	55%	4.43	4.52	2		
January	2022	MATH 111	32	20	63%	4.61	4.52	6		
August	2022	MATH 106	34	25	74%	4.67	4.49	8		
October	2022	MATH 111	20	14	70%	4.91	4.75	4		
January	2023	MATH 111	34	19	56%	4.61	4.46	5	1	
March	2023	MATH 111	35	21	60%	4.75	4.46	7		
August	2023	MATH 111	24	16	67%	4.84	4.52	7		
October	2023	MATH 111	29	14	48%	4.63	4.43	4		
January	2024	CSCI 251	4	4	100%	4.72	4.53	2		
August	2024	CSCI 251	6	3	50%	4.15	4.56	2		
August	2024	MATH 502	17	8	47%	4.78	4.56	5	1	
January	2025	MATH 502	20	16	80%	4.62	4.55	5	1	
August	2025	STAT 412	15	8	53%	4.74	4.67	1		
August	2025	MATH 502	11	8	73%	4.45	4.67	5	2	
October	2025	DSCI 201	10	5	50%	4.8	4.67	5		
October	2025	STAT 412	15	8	53%	4.75	4.67	1		
January	2026	CSCI 251	9	6	67%	5	4.65	3		
January	2026	MATH 502	25	17	68%	4.71	4.65	1		

Curriculum Development

A better measure of my effectiveness as an instructor is in the evaluation of curriculum I have developed. When creating courses, I create all homework assignments (no third-party homework platforms), write summarized notes of open-source textbooks, and ensure students have a balance of assignments that target conceptual, technical, and metacognitive development.

CSCI 251 - Introduction to Programming for Data Science: This new course, initially built for the Minor in Applied Data Science and later incorporated into the Bachelors in Data Science, teaches students how to program in order to manage and analyze large data sets. The courses does not use any paid third party platform – all learning resources and assignments were created for the ERAU-WW course specifically. Some of these are traditional assignments, such as open-response Canvas quizzes, while others encourage active groupwork, such as groups developing documentation specific to the course. This allows students to get genuine feedback before they write entire programs on their own. Students universally praised the course, with comments such as:

The course was fantastic, the instructor's assignments were consistent and understandable,

challenging but never overwhelming. (Jan 2026)

All of the different teaching methods were really helpful. . . What helped most of all was being able to get my hands on the program itself and experiment with it and just have fun with it. (Jan 2026)

As one of the first courses in both the minor and bachelors' programs, it is important to have an engaging and interesting course to entice students to continue their program.

DSCI 201 - Introduction to Applied Data Science: Another instructor who is no longer at ERAU created DSCI 201 but did not teach it before leaving. The course was rife with low-level engagement assignments that only required students to write a couple sentences based on something they read. I began creating engaging assignments that utilized students' coding skills to implement machine learning algorithms. Comparative examples of assignments are provided in [**Optional Teaching Artifact - DSCI 201 Comparison**]. Students praised my progressive edits to the course with comments such as:

I found the course well-paced and interesting. The instructor was engaging and encouraging. (Oct 2026)

I would recommend that the videos Dr. Chamberlain made for CSCI 251 be used for this course, as I found them especially helpful and easy to follow along with. (Oct 2026)

The Jupyter notebooks along with specific examples online and linking to the documentation helped me see the learning objectives clearly. (Oct 2026)

Math 111 - Pre-Calculus for Aviation: In the first update, I rewrote the majority of discussions to improve students' metaskills as well as encourage students to engage with content beyond drilling skills. By metaskills, I mean students' ability to reflect on their study skills and evaluate mathematical work. Early discussions were designed to improve how students study for mathematics: both in study habits and with actually creating study materials. Later discussions focus on difficult mathematical concepts such as vector movement. One discussion in particular has received both hate and love by adjuncts. The question requires students to reason how to compensate for wind when flying between two cities. The question is written so that there are numerous ways students can reason through and "solve" for the specific correction in the problem. This led to instructor comments such as:

I have a feeling that this problem could be too complicated in an introductory level course. Admittedly, even I had a hard time figuring out how to tackle this problem until I looked at the solution guide. I have never seen such an applied vector problem before this one.

Attached are three students approach to the problem. The Answer Key provided shows a different approach to working the problem. Could you look over these students approach and provide me with any suggestions on how to best help them?

Several of my students have asked for the velocity or speed of the airplane. I told them they have all the information that is needed to solve the problem and suggested that they make a sketch. I am afraid this isn't going to go too well!

The new Module 7 Group Discussion Exercise in Math 111 was a tremendous addition to the course. Cognitive presence was demonstrated significantly in the various ways students sketched, formulated, solved and analyzed the given problem. Several students supplemented the work of others through extensive collaboration and tackling the problem from different angles. . . literally and figuratively! This was a welcome addition to an "aviation" course which up until recently didn't have many aviation applications or examples.

All of these comments point to an increased cognitive demand for the discussion post. Many students were and continue to be able to reason through the discussion post by the end of the week. This suggests the question is not too complicated, but IS a spike in difficulty from what they might see on the homework and exams. The second comment in particular highlights how there is no one way to reason through the task, which was precisely the point. The third comment points to the need for instructors to engage with the task beyond "correct" or "incorrect" and thus provides a genuine opportunity for teacher-to-student learning.